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Education

- 2016–2022 **Ph.D. Economics**, *Columbia University*, New York, USA.
2011–2012 **M.A. Economics**, *Universidad de los Andes*, Bogotá, Colombia.
2007–2010 **B.A. Political Science**, *Universidad de los Andes*, Bogotá, Colombia.
2006–2010 **B.A. Economics**, *Universidad de los Andes*, Bogotá, Colombia.

Research Interests

Education and Labor economics, Development Economics, Political Economy, Economic History

Professional Experience

- 2025–today **Peking University HSBC Business School**, *Assistant Professor*.
Shenzhen, China.
2022–2025 **New York University -Abu Dhabi**, *Post-Doctoral Associate*.
Abu Dhabi, UAE.
2014–2016 **Inter-American Development Bank**, *Research Fellow*.
Washington, DC USA.
2013–2014 **J-PAL LAC**, *Research Analyst*.
Santiago, Chile.
2010–2013 **Universidad del Rosario**, *Research Assistant*.
Bogotá, Colombia.

Publications

Social distancing and COVID-19 under violence: Evidence from Colombia, with Diego Martin (2024) *Journal of Development Economics*, Volume 170.

Short- and long-run labor market adjustment to import competition, with Juan Blyde, Matias Busso and Kyunglin Park (2023) *Review of International Economics*, pp.1- 18.

Selective Civilian Targeting: The Unintended Consequences of Partial Peace, with Mounu Prem, Andres Rivera and Juan Vargas (2022) *Quarterly Journal of Political Science*, vol. 7(3), pp.317- 354.

The Perils of High-Powered Incentives: Evidence from Colombia's False Positives, with Daron Acemoglu, Leopoldo Fergusson, James Robinson and Juan Fernando Vargas (2020). *American Economic Journal: Economic Policy*, vol. 12(3), pp.1- 43.

Improving Access to Preventive Maternal Health Care Using Reminders: Experimental Evidence from Guatemala. With Matias Busso and Dario Salcedo (2017), *Economic Letters*, vol. 161, pp. 43-46.

Books or laptops? The effect of shifting from printed to digital delivery of educational content on learning. With Rosangela Bando, Francisco Gallego and Paul J. Gertler (2017). *Economics of*

Education Review, vol. 61, pp. 162-173

The effects of financial aid and returns information in selective and less selective schools: Experimental evidence from Chile. With Matias Busso, Taryn Dinkelman and Claudia Martínez (2017). *Labour Economics*, Vol. 45, pp. 79-91.

Insecurity or Perception of Insecurity? Urban Crime and Dissatisfaction with Life: Evidence from the Case of Bogotá. (2014). *Peace Economics, Peace Science and Public Policy*, Vol. 20(1), pp. 169-208.

Chapters in Books

Facts and Determinants of Female Labor Supply in Latin America, with Matias Busso. In “Bridging gender gaps? The rise and deceleration of female labor force participation in Latin America”, Leonardo Gasparini and Mariana Marchioni (Eds), 2015.

Working Papers

Something Biased This Way Comes: The Effect of Media on House Elections in the US (With Haaris Mateen)

Soft Training, Hard Repression: U.S. Military Training and Democracy (With Diego Martin)

The Environmental Impact of Civil Conflict: The Deforestation Effect of Paramilitary Expansion in Colombia, with Leopoldo Fergusson and Juan F. Vargas, Cede Working Paper 2014-36.

Downwind of the Bus Lane: Transit Pollution and Academic Performance (with Diego Martin and Dario Salcedo)

Clouded Judgment? Air Pollution, Cognition, and Invalid Voting (with Diego Martin and Dario Salcedo). SSRN Working Paper

Media Slant, Erosion of Trust, and Financial Decisions (With Haaris Mateen and Elizabeth Berger)

Imperial Threads: Trade Protectionism and the Direction of Innovation

Work in progress

Political Polarization and Inventor Productivity: Evidence from Local Television Markets in the US (With Haaris Mateen and Po-Hsuan Hsu)

Mass Deportations, Economic Networks and Firm Productivity in Guatemala (With Carlos Schmidt-Padilla) [Data collection]

History of State Presence in Brazil (With Felipe Netto)

Teaching Experience

2026 **Political Institutions and Economic Development (Module 4)**, *Instructor*, Peking University HSBC Business School.

2025 **Political Institutions and Economic Development (Module 2)**, *Instructor*, Peking University HSBC Business School.

2025 **Fundamental Analysis in Economics (Module 2)**, *Instructor*, Peking University HSBC Business School.

Summer 2021, Fall **Introduction to Econometrics (Undergraduate)**, *TA*, Columbia University.

2020 *Instructor*: Seyhan Erden

Spring 2021	Game Theory (Undergraduate) , <i>TA, Columbia University</i> . Instructor: Qingmin Liu
Spring 2021	Perspectives on Economic Studies (Ph.D. 1st Year course) , <i>TA, Columbia University</i> . Instructor: Joseph Stiglitz and Suresh Naidu
Fall 2019, Fall 2017	Political Economy (Undergraduate) , <i>TA, Columbia University</i> . Instructor: John Marshall
Fall 2018	Political Economy (Undergraduate) , <i>TA, Columbia University</i> . Instructor: Alessandra Casella
Spring 2018	Principles of Economics (Undergraduate) , <i>TA, Columbia University</i> . Instructor: Nicola Zaniboni

Conference and Presentations

2025	RIDGE Lima, Koç University, Bilkent University, HSBC, AEDE Milan
2024	RIDGE Santiago, EEA-ESEM Rotterdam, LACEA Montevideo
2023	RIDGE Montevideo, EHES Vienna, ESOC Washington DC
2022	U. de los Andes (Bogotá), INSPER (Sao Pablo), U. Javeriana (Bogotá)
2021	LACEA, Bogotá
2019	LACEA, Puebla

Professional Service

Refereeing

The Quarterly Journal of Economics, Journal of Development Economics, Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization, Journal of the European Economic Association, Review of International Economics, Oxford Bulletin of Economics and Statistics, Revista Cuadernos de Economía

Computer skills

Statistical	Stata, SPSS, Eviews, R, Matlab, Python
Geographical	ArcGIS, QGIS, GeoDa
Word Processor	MS Office, L ^A T _E X, Beamer

Languages

Spanish	Native	English	Fluent
Portuguese	Intermediate	German	Intermediate
French	Beginner	Italian	Beginner
Arabic	Basic		

Writing Samples

Soft Training, Hard Repression: U.S. Military Training and Democracy (With Diego Martin)

We study the effect of U.S. foreign military training on the behaviour of officers upon returning to their home countries. We exploit quasi-experimental variation in the assignment of commanders trained at the School of the Americas, a U.S. facility that trained close to 2,000 Latin American military personnel per year for four decades. Our estimates show that SOA-trained commanders eroded democratic institutions and increased civilian-directed operations, including forced disappearances, with no operational gains against armed groups. We also analyse declassified SOA training manuals and find no explicit instruction to target civilians, but evidence that the manuals blurred the doctrinal boundary between counterinsurgency and civilian control. Latinobarometer surveys show that exposed cohorts are more supportive of democracy and trust less in the military. These findings document a human capital channel through which foreign military assistance can undermine institutions it is designed to strengthen through increased civilian repression.

Something Biased This Way Comes: The Effect of Media on Local Elections in US (With Haaris Mateen)

Using the staggered expansion of Sinclair Broadcast Group (SBG), a conservative leaning TV station operator, from 2012 to 2017, we study how introducing a biased TV station operator affects electoral outcomes. We use the failed acquisition by SBG of a major station operator to control for the selection effect of market entry. Our findings reveal that SBG acquisition increases the likelihood of a Republican candidate winning House elections, contrasting with a negative impact on Republican performance in presidential elections. Importantly, we document a persistent ideological shift to more conservatism for the winner in House elections, which strengthens over time. When decomposing the ideological effect, we find a shift to relatively more conservatism for *both* Republicans and Democratic candidates in the House elections, even though the pool of Democratic candidates in the primaries becomes more liberal on average. Additionally, we show that Republican candidates receive increased donations in SBG-acquired areas. This study underscores the significance of analyzing electoral settings beyond national elections where not only voters' preferences but also candidates' strategies and ideology are influenced, highlighting the potential impact of biased media on electoral outcomes and the importance of media ownership regulations.

Imperial Threads: Trade Protectionism and the Direction of Innovation (Submitted)

Captive colonial markets shape innovation in ways that outlast the markets themselves. Spain's colonial system created a captive market for cotton textiles through two complementary reforms: a 1882 bilateral preference agreement and a 1891 increase in domestic protection. Neither reform alone was sufficient to redirect inventive activity toward cotton. Exploiting variation across different textile fibers, I find that cotton patenting rose by 13.5 patents per category relative to other fibers at the peak of colonial access, driven by domestic inventors rather than the adoption of foreign technology and accompanied by a significant expansion of mechanized looms. A significant share of the innovation response occurred after Spain lost its colonies in 1898, consistent with path dependence through knowledge spillovers rather than persistent protection. A directed-technical-change model formalizes the complementarity between the two reforms and shows that the composition of colonial demand, rather than domestic market size alone, is what redirected innovation. These findings establish that the structure of captive markets can permanently shift an economy's technological trajectory.